

Clitophon

ΚΛΕΙΤΟΦΩΝ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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S: Someone told us recently that Clitophon¹, the son of Aristonymus, in conversation with Lysias², was critical of Socrates' discourses, while his praise of the instruction of Thrasymachus³ knew no bounds.

ΣΩ. Κλειτοφῶντα τὸν Ἀριστωνύμου τις ἡμῖν διηγεῖτο ἔναγχος, ὅτι Λυσία διαλεγόμενος τὰς μὲν μετὰ Σωκράτους διατριβὰς ψέγοι, τὴν Θρασυμάχου δὲ συνουσίαν ὑπερεπαινοῖ. ΚΛΕΙ. ὅστις, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐκ ὀρθῶς ἀπεμνημόνευέ σοι τοὺς ἐμοὶ περὶ σοῦ γενομένους λόγους πρὸς Λυσίαν· τὰ μὲν γὰρ ἔγωγε οὐκ ἐπὶήνουν σε, τὰ δὲ καὶ ἐπὶήνουν. ἐπεὶ δὲ δῆλος εἶ μεμφόμενος μὲν μοι, προσποιούμενος δὲ μηδὲν φροντίζειν, ἥδιστ' ἂν σοι διεξέλθοιμι αὐτοὺς αὐτός, ἐπειδὴ καὶ μόνω τυγχάνομεν ὄντε, ἵνα ἡττόν με ἡγῇ πρὸς σέ φαύλως ἔχειν. νῦν γὰρ ἴσως οὐκ ὀρθῶς ἀκήκοας, ὥστε φαίνῃ πρὸς ἐμὲ ἔχειν τραχυτέρως τοῦ δέοντος· εἰ δέ μοι δίδως παρρησίαν, ἥδιστα ἂν δεξαίμην καὶ ἐθέλω λέγειν.

L: Whoever said so, Socrates, misinformed you about the discussion I had with Lysias concerning yourself. For although in some respects I did not praise you, in other respects I did. But since you are obviously rebuking me, while pretending to be unconcerned, I would be glad to recount these discussions to you myself now that we are on our own, so that you may be less inclined to believe that I think badly of you. Indeed, at the moment what you have heard is probably incorrect, and so you seem to be somewhat harder on me than I deserve. But if you allow me to speak freely, I'll do so gladly as I wish to explain myself.

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S: Well, it would indeed be a shame for me to be intolerant when you are so eager to benefit me. For obviously, having recognised in what way I am good or bad, I shall practise and pursue the one and flee from the other as best I can.

ΣΩ. ἀλλ' αἰσχρὸν μὴν σοῦ γε ὠφελεῖν με προθυμουμένου μὴ ὑπομένειν· δῆλον γὰρ ὡς γνοὺς ὅπη χείρων εἰμὶ καὶ βελτίων, τὰ μὲν ἀσκήσω καὶ διώξομαι, τὰ δὲ φεύξομαι κατὰ κράτος. ΚΛΕΙ. ἀκούεις ἄν. ἐγὼ γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες, σοὶ συγγιγνόμενος πολλάκις ἐξεπληττόμην ἀκούων, καί μοι

ἐδόκεις παρὰ τοὺς ἄλλους ἀνθρώπους κάλλιστα λέγειν, ὅποτε ἐπιτιμῶν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, ὥσπερ ἐπὶ μηχανῆς τραγικῆς θεός, ὕμνεις

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L: Listen then, for, while in your company, I was often amazed at what I was hearing, and I thought that in comparison with other speakers your discourse was the most exalted, as you rebuked the people like a god descending upon the tragic stage chanting your words: “People, whither are you being carried, ignorant of the fact that you are doing nothing you should do, you who are so utterly serious about money and acquiring it for yourselves? Yet in the case of your sons to whom you will bequeath all this, you seek out no teachers of justice so that they will know how to use the wealth in a just manner, if this is actually teachable. But even if this is a matter of practice and exercise, you don’t look for anyone who is up to the task of training them thoroughly and guiding them carefully, nor have you looked after yourselves in this way. Rather, when you see that yourselves and your children still prove to fare no better when it comes to using your wealth, despite being adequately instructed in writing, music and gymnastics, which you regard as a complete education in excel- that brother behaves towards brother and cities towards cities in an unmeasured and discordant manner, through conflict and warfare in which they carry out and suffer extremes of depravity. Yet you maintain that unjust people are unjust not because of a lack of education or because of ignorance, but intentionally, and again you dare to say further that injustice is shameful and detested by the gods. Now, how could anyone intentionally choose such an evil as this? Because, you reply, he is overcome by pleasures. But this is also unintentional, is it not, since to prevail is intentional? In any case, the argument proves that doing injustice is unintentional, and every man privately, and likewise all cities publicly, should exercise more care about this than they do at present.” Now, Socrates, whenever I hear you saying all this, as you frequently do, I am much pleased, and I praise you wondrously; and also whenever you go on after this to say that

those who develop their bodies but neglect souls are doing something else of this sort by being neglectful of the part that should rule, while attending to the part that should be ruled; and also when you say that it is better for someone to refrain from using whatever he knows not how to use. As, for instance, when someone knows not how to use eyes, ears or body as a whole, it is better for him neither to hear nor see nor use his body for any other purpose rather than using it in any way whatsoever. And, indeed, the same holds for skill, since whoever does not know how to use his own lyre obviously does not know how to use his neighbour's lyre either, nor does anyone who does not know how to use other people's lyres know how to use his own lyre, nor any other instrument or possession at all. And this argument of yours then beautifully concludes that whoever knows not how to use soul is better off keeping his soul quiescent and not living at all, rather than being alive and acting according to his own whims. And if it is necessary for such a person to be alive, it is better that he spend his life as a slave rather than a free man, entrusting the rudder of his mind, just like a ship, to someone else who had learned the skill of steering humanity, which you, Socrates, often call statesmanship, saying that this is the same as jurisprudence and justice. Now, I have nothing to say against these arguments, and very many others of this sort, wonderfully expressed, stating that excellence is teachable and that we should care most of all for our own self. I do not really have anything to say against these, and I don't think I ever will, and I believe that they are exhortative in the extreme, and beneficial too, as if we are simply asleep and these are waking us up. So, I paid attention in order to hear what was to follow this, putting my questions, initially, not to yourself, Socrates, but to your like-minded comrades or companions, or whatever such associates of yours should be called. I first questioned those whom you held in the highest regard, asking them what argument would come next, and somewhat after your manner, I made a suggestion to them. "Best of men," said I, "how are we now to take Socrates' exhortation that we turn towards excellence? Is this all there

is to say, and is it not possible to pursue the matter further and understand it completely? Is it to be our lifelong task to exhort those who have not yet been exhorted, and are they in turn to exhort others? Or should we ask Socrates, and one another, a further question; having agreed that this is exactly what a human being is to do, what follows? How, according to us, should we start learning about justice? It's as if someone exhorted us to care for the body, having observed that we, like children, were unaware that there is such a thing as gymnastics and medicine. What if he were to reproach us on this basis, saying that it is a disgrace to care totally for wheat and barley and vines and whatever else we work for and acquire for the sake of the body, while searching neither for a skill nor a means whereby the body might be in as good a condition as possible, even though there are such skills? And what if we were to question the person who exhorted us in this way by asking him what these skills are? He would probably reply that these are gymnastics and medicine. In the present case then, what, according to us, is the skill concerned with the excellence of the soul? What do you say?" The one among them who was regarded as the most formidable in these matters replied to me. He told me what this skill was. "It is," said he, "the very one you hear Socrates speaking of, none other than justice." I replied by saying, "Don't just tell me its name. No, proceed as follows. Medicine is, presumably, a skill of which there are two outcomes, the first being ongoing production of additional physicians, the second being health. But the second of these is not yet a skill; it is rather the result of the skill of teaching and being taught, a result we call health. Similarly, in the case of the carpenter's skill, there is the house and there is carpentry, one being a result, the other being a subject that is taught. And the same applies to justice; one outcome is the production of just people in the same way that the other skills produce people with those particular skills. But what is its other outcome, the result that the just man can produce for us? What do we say this is? Tell me." That man replied, I believe, that it is 'the advantageous', another said that it is 'the appropriate', someone else

suggested ‘the beneficial’, another ‘the profitable’. So, I returned to the question and said, “In the other realm too, these terms such as acting correctly, being profitable, beneficial, and so on, are applicable to any of the skills. But to what are these all directed? Each skill will give its own reply, and so carpentry, for instance, will say that what is good, beautiful, and necessary, is directed to the provision of wooden objects, which are, of course, not the skill itself. So, describe the result of justice in like manner.” Finally, Socrates, one of your companions replied with what seemed like the most ingenious response, saying that the particular result of justice, which belongs to none of the other skills, is to produce friendship in cities. This man, when questioned further, said that friendship is good and is never bad, and as the questioning continued, he would not accept that what we refer to as the friendship of children and beasts is indeed friendship. For he had to conclude that such friendships are, for the most part, harmful rather than good. So to avoid such a conclusion, he said that such friendships are not friendships at all, and that anyone who refers to them in this way is naming them falsely. And he said that real and true friendship is, precisely, like-mindedness. When asked whether he would say that the like-mindedness is likeness of opinion or of knowledge, he did not favour likeness of opinion because it is unavoidable that many instances of harmful likeness of opinion occur among people, while he had agreed that friendship is entirely good and is a result of justice. And so, he said like-mindedness was the same, being knowledge and not opinion. Now, at this stage in the argument we were getting nowhere. But those present were well able to take him to task and say that the argument had come full circle back to where we began and they said, “Medicine too is a sort of like-mindedness, and so are all of the skills and they are all able to say what they are concerned with. But what you call justice or like-mindedness has completely forgotten what it is directed towards, and there is no clarity as to what precisely the result of justice is.” That’s why, Socrates, in the end, I also put the question to you, and you told me that justice is doing harm to enemies

and good to friends. But later it turned out that a just person never harms anyone, since everything he does to anyone is for their benefit. Having been patient with this process, not once or twice but over a considerable time, my persistence failed me, and although I believe you are better than anyone at exhorting people to care for excellence, there are two possibilities; either this is as much as you can do and you can do no more, as if someone, without being a helmsman, were to teach himself to praise this skill as being of great value to humanity. And the same analogy applies to any of the skills, and so, in relation to justice, someone might accuse you of being none the more knowledgeable about justice simply because you are good at praising it. Now, I myself don't think that this is the case, but there are two possibilities: either you are not knowledgeable or you are unwilling to share your knowledge with me. I think that's why, in my perplexity, I go to Thrasymachus and to anyone else I can. But if you are prepared at this stage to stop giving me these exhortatory speeches, that's what should happen now. Act as if I had been exhorted, in respect of gymnastics, not to neglect my body. Following your exhortatory speech, you would then explain the nature of my body and the sort of care it needs. Take it then that Clitophon agrees that it is laughable to care for other things while neglecting the soul for whose sake we work so hard at everything else. And at this stage you should also presume that I have, in this way, said whatever follows those arguments that I have gone through just now. So, I am saying, please just do as I ask so that I won't do what I am now doing, praising you before Lysias, and before others in some respects, while criticising you in other respects. Indeed, Socrates, I declare that you are worth everything to a person who has not yet been exhorted, but to someone who has already been exhorted, you almost get in the way of their attaining happiness by arriving at complete excellence.

λέγων· ποῖ φέρεσθε, ὄνθρωποι; καὶ ἀγνοεῖτε οὐδὲν τῶν δεόντων πράττοντες, οἵτινες χρημάτων μὲν περὶ τὴν πᾶσαν σπουδὴν ἔχετε ὅπως ὑμῖν ἔσται, τῶν δ' ὑέων οἷς ταῦτα παραδώσετε ὅπως ἐπιστήσονται

χρῆσθαι δικαίως τούτοις, οὔτε διδασκάλους αὐτοῖς εὐρίσκετε τῆς δικαιοσύνης, εἴπερ μαθητόν—εἰ δὲ μελετητόν τε καὶ ἀσκητόν, οἵτινες ἐξασκήσουσιν καὶ ἐκμελετήσουσιν ἱκανῶς—οὐδέ γ' ἔτι πρότερον ὑμᾶς αὐτοὺς οὕτως ἐθεραπεύσατε. ἀλλ' ὁρῶντες γράμματα καὶ μουσικὴν καὶ γυμναστικὴν ὑμᾶς τε αὐτοὺς καὶ τοὺς παῖδας ὑμῶν ἱκανῶς μεμαθηκότας—ἀ δὴ παιδεῖαν ἀρετῆς εἶναι τελέαν ἠγείσθε—κάππειτα οὐδὲν ἦττον κακοὺς γιγνομένους περὶ τὰ χρήματα, πῶς οὐ καταφρονεῖτε τῆς νῦν παιδεύσεως οὐδὲ ζητεῖτε οἵτινες ὑμᾶς παύσουσι ταύτης τῆς ἀμουσίας; καίτοι διὰ γε ταύτην τὴν πλημμέλειαν καὶ ῥαθυμίαν, ἀλλ' οὐ διὰ τὴν ἐν τῷ ποδὶ πρὸς τὴν λύραν ἀμετρίαν, καὶ ἀδελφὸς ἀδελφῷ καὶ πόλεις πόλεσιν ἀμέτρως καὶ ἀναρμόστως προσφερόμεναι στασιάζουσι καὶ πολεμοῦντες τὰ ἔσχατα δρῶσιν καὶ πάσχουσιν. ὑμεῖς δέ φατε οὐ δι' ἀπαιδευσίαν οὐδὲ δι' ἄγνοιαν ἀλλ' ἐκόντας τοὺς ἀδίκους ἀδίκους εἶναι, πάλιν δ' αὖ τολμᾶτε λέγειν ὡς αἰσχρὸν καὶ θεομισὲς ἡ ἀδικία πῶς οὖν δή τις τό γε τοιοῦτον κακὸν ἐκὼν αἰροῖτ' ἄν; "Ἦττων ὃς ἂν ᾗ, φατέ, τῶν ἡδονῶν. οὐκοῦν καὶ τοῦτο ἀκούσιον, εἴπερ τὸ νικᾶν ἐκούσιον; ὥστε ἐκ παντὸς τρόπου τό γε ἀδικεῖν ἀκούσιον ὁ λόγος αἰρεῖ, καὶ δεῖν ἐπιμέλειαν τῆς νῦν πλείω ποιεῖσθαι πάντ' ἄνδρα ἰδίᾳ θ' ἅμα καὶ δημοσίᾳ συμπάσας τὰς πόλεις. ταῦτ' οὖν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐγὼ ὅταν ἀκούω σοῦ θαμὰ λέγοντος, καὶ μάλα ἄγαμαι καὶ θαυμαστῶς ὡς ἐπαινῶ. καὶ ὁπόταν αὖ φῆς τὸ ἐφεξῆς τούτῳ, τοὺς ἀσχοῦντας μὲν τὰ σώματα, τῆς δὲ ψυχῆς ἡμεληκότας ἕτερόν τι πράττειν τοιοῦτον, τοῦ μὲν ἄρξοντος ἀμελεῖν, περὶ δὲ τὸ ἀρξόμενον ἐσπουδακέναι. καὶ ὅταν λέγῃς ὡς ὅτῳ τις μὴ ἐπίσταται χρῆσθαι, κρεῖττον ἔαν τὴν τούτου χρῆσιν· εἰ δὴ τις μὴ ἐπίσταται ὀφθαλμοῖς χρῆσθαι μηδὲ ὥσιν μηδὲ σύμπαντι τῷ σώματι, τούτῳ μήτε ἀκούειν μήθ' ὁρᾶν μήτ' ἄλλην χρεῖαν μηδεμίαν χρῆσθαι τῷ σώματι κρεῖττον ἢ ὀπηροῦν χρῆσθαι. ΚΛΕΙ. καὶ δὴ καὶ περὶ τέχνην ὡσαύτως· ὅστις γὰρ δὴ μὴ ἐπίσταται τῇ ἑαυτοῦ λύρᾳ χρῆσθαι, δῆλον ὡς οὐδὲ τῇ τοῦ γείτονος, οὐδὲ ὅστις μὴ τῇ τῶν ἄλλων, οὐδὲ τῇ ἑαυτοῦ, οὐδ' ἄλλῳ τῶν ὀργάνων οὐδὲ κτημάτων οὐδενί. καὶ τελευτᾷ δὴ καλῶς ὁ λόγος οὗτός σοι, ὡς ὅστις ψυχῇ μὴ ἐπίσταται χρῆσθαι, τούτῳ τὸ ἄγειν ἡσυχίαν τῇ ψυχῇ καὶ μὴ ζῆν κρεῖττον ἢ ζῆν πράττοντι καθ' αὐτόν· εἰ δέ τις ἀνάγκη ζῆν εἴη,

δούλῳ ἄμεινον ἢ ἐλευθέρῳ διάγειν τῷ τοιούτῳ τὸν βίον ἐστὶν ἄρα, καθάπερ πλοίου παραδόντι τὰ πηδάλια τῆς διανοίας ἄλλῳ, τῷ μαθόντι τὴν τῶν ἀνθρώπων κυβερνητικὴν, ἣν δὴ σὺ πολιτικὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπονομάζεις πολλάκις, τὴν αὐτὴν δὴ ταύτην δικαστικὴν τε καὶ δικαιοσύνην ὡς ἔστιν λέγων. τούτοις δὴ τοῖς λόγοις καὶ ἑτέροις τοιούτοις παμπόλλοις καὶ παγκάλως λεγομένοις, ὡς διδακτὸν ἀρετῇ καὶ πάντων ἑαυτοῦ δεῖ μάλιστα ἐπιμελεῖσθαι, σχεδὸν οὐτ' ἀντεῖπον πώποτε οὐτ' οἶμαι μήποτε ὕστερον ἀντεῖπω, προτρεπτικωτάτους τε ἡγοῦμαι καὶ ὠφελιμωτάτους, καὶ ἀτεχνῶς ὥσπερ καθεύδοντας ἐπεγείρειν ἡμᾶς. προσεῖχον δὴ τὸν νοῦν τὸ μετὰ ταῦτα ὡς ἀκουσόμενος, ἐπανερωτῶν οὐτι σὲ τὸ πρῶτον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλὰ τῶν ἡλικιωτῶν τε καὶ συνεπιθυμητῶν ἢ ἐταίρων σῶν, ἢ ὅπως δεῖ πρὸς σὲ περὶ αὐτῶν τὸ τοιοῦτον ὀνομάζειν. τούτων γὰρ τοὺς τί μάλιστα εἶναι δοξαζομένους ὑπὸ σοῦ πρώτους ἐπανηρώτων, πυνθανόμενος τίς ὁ μετὰ ταῦτ' εἴη λόγος, καὶ κατὰ σὲ τρόπον τινὰ ὑποτείνων αὐτοῖς, ὦ βέλτιστοι, ἔφην, ὑμεῖς, πῶς ποτε νῦν ἀποδεχόμεθα τὴν Σωκράτους προτροπὴν ἡμῶν ἐπ' ἀρετῇ; ὥς ὄντος μόνου τούτου, ἐπεξελθεῖν δὲ οὐκ ἔνι τῷ πράγματι καὶ λαβεῖν αὐτὸ τελέως, ἀλλ' ἡμῖν παρὰ πάντα δὴ τὸν βίον ἔργον τοῦτ' ἔσται, τοὺς μήπω προτετραμμένους προτρέπειν, καὶ ἐκείνους αὖ ἑτέρους; ἢ δεῖ τὸν Σωκράτη καὶ ἀλλήλους ἡμᾶς τὸ μετὰ τοῦτ' ἐπανερωτᾶν, ὁμολογήσαντας τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἀνθρώπῳ πρακτέον εἶναι, τί τούντεῦθεν; πῶς ἄρχεσθαι δεῖν φαμεν δικαιοσύνης πέρι μαθήσεως; ὥσπερ ἂν εἴ τις ἡμᾶς προύτρεπεν τοῦ σώματος ἐπιμέλειαν ποιεῖσθαι, μηδὲν προνοοῦντας ὁρῶν καθάπερ παῖδας ὡς ἔστιν τις γυμναστικὴ καὶ ἰατρικὴ, κᾶπειτα ὠνείδιζεν, λέγων ὡς αἰσχρὸν πυρῶν μὲν καὶ κριθῶν καὶ ἀμπέλων ἐπιμέλειαν πᾶσαν ποιεῖσθαι, καὶ ὅσα τοῦ σώματος ἔνεκα διαπονούμεθά τε καὶ κτῶμεθα, τούτου δ' αὐτοῦ μηδεμίαν τέχνην μηδὲ μηχανήν, ὅπως ὡς βέλτιστον ἔσται τὸ σῶμα, ἐξευρίσκειν, καὶ ταῦτα οὕσαν. ΚΛΕΙ. εἰ δ' ἐπανηρόμεθα τὸν ταῦθ' ἡμᾶς προτρέποντα λέγεις δὲ εἶναι τίνας ταύτας τὰς τέχνας; εἶπεν ἂν ἴσως ὅτι γυμναστικὴ καὶ ἰατρικὴ. καὶ νῦν δὴ τίνα φαμέν εἶναι τὴν ἐπὶ τῇ τῆς ψυχῆς ἀρετῇ τέχνην; λεγέσθω. ὁ δὲ δοκῶν αὐτῶν ἐρρωμενέστατος εἶναι πρὸς ταῦτα ἀποκρινόμενος εἶπέν μοι ταύτην τὴν τέχνην εἶναι

ἦνπερ ἀκούεις σὺ λέγοντος, ἔφη, Σωκράτους, οὐκ ἄλλην ἢ δικαιοσύνην. εἰπόντος δ' ἐμοῦ μή μοι τὸ ὄνομα μόνον εἴπης, ἀλλὰ ὧδε. ἱατρικὴ ποῦ τις λέγεται τέχνη ταύτης δ' ἐστὶν διττὰ τὰ ἀποτελούμενα, τὸ μὲν ἱατροῦς ἀεὶ πρὸς τοῖς οὖσιν ἐτέρους ἐξεργάζεσθαι, τὸ δὲ ὑγίειαν ἔστιν δὲ τούτων θάτερον οὐκέτι τέχνη, τῆς τέχνης δὲ τῆς διδασκούσης τε καὶ διδασκομένης ἔργον, ὃ δὴ λέγομεν ὑγίειαν. καὶ τεκτονικῆς δὲ κατὰ ταῦτ' αἰκία τε καὶ τεκτονικὴ τὸ μὲν ἔργον, τὸ δὲ δίδαγμα. τῆς δὲ δικαιοσύνης ὡσαύτως τὸ μὲν δικαίους ἔστω ποιεῖν, καθάπερ ἐκεῖ τοὺς τεχνίτας ἐκάστους· τὸ δ' ἕτερον, ὃ δύναται ποιεῖν ἡμῖν ἔργον ὁ δίκαιος, τί τοῦτό φαμεν; εἰπέ. οὗτος μὲν, ὡς οἶμαι, τὸ συμφέρον ἀπεκρίνατο, ἄλλος δὲ τὸ δέον, ἕτερος δὲ τὸ ὠφέλιμον, ὃ δὲ τὸ λυσιτελοῦν. ἐπαρήγειν δὴ ἐγὼ λέγων ὅτι κακεῖ τὰ γε ὀνόματα ταῦτ' ἐστὶν ἐν ἐκάστη τῶν τεχνῶν, ὁρθῶς πράττειν, λυσιτελοῦντα, ὠφέλιμα καὶ τᾶλλα τὰ τοιαῦτα· ἀλλὰ πρὸς ὅτι ταῦτα πάντα τείνει, ἔρεῖ τὸ ἴδιον ἐκάστη ἢ τέχνη, οἷον ἢ τεκτονικὴ τὸ εὖ, τὸ καλῶς, τὸ δεόντως, ὥστε τὰ ξύλινα, φήσει, σκευὴ γίνεσθαι, ἃ δὴ οὐκ ἔστιν τέχνη. λεγέσθω δὴ καὶ τὸ τῆς δικαιοσύνης ὡσαύτως. τελευτῶν ἀπεκρίνατό τις ὃ Σώκρατες μοι τῶν σῶν ἐταίρων, ὃς δὴ κομψότατα ἔδοξεν εἰπεῖν, ὅτι τοῦτ' εἴη τὸ τῆς δικαιοσύνης ἴδιον ἔργον, ὃ τῶν ἄλλων οὐδεμιᾶς, φιλίαν ἐν ταῖς πόλεσιν ποιεῖν. οὗτος δ' αὖ ἐρωτώμενος τὴν φιλίαν ἀγαθὸν τ' ἔφη εἶναι καὶ οὐδέποτε κακόν, τὰς δὲ τῶν παίδων φιλίας καὶ τὰς τῶν θηρίων, ἃς ἡμεῖς τοῦτο τοῦνομα ἐπονομάζομεν, οὐκ ἀπεδέχετο εἶναι φιλίας ἐπανερωτώμενος· συνέβαινε γὰρ αὐτῷ τὰ πλείω τὰς τοιαύτας βλαβεράς ἢ ἀγαθὰς εἶναι. φεύγων δὲ τὸ τοιοῦτον οὐδὲ φιλίας ἔφη τὰς τοιαύτας εἶναι, ψευδῶς δὲ ὀνομάζειν αὐτὰς τοὺς οὕτως ὀνομάζοντας· τὴν δὲ ὄντως καὶ ἀληθῶς φιλίαν εἶναι σαφέστατα ὁμόνοιαν. τὴν δὲ ὁμόνοιαν ἐρωτώμενος εἰ ὁμοδοξίαν εἶναι λέγοι ἢ ἐπιστήμην, τὴν μὲν ὁμοδοξίαν ἠτίμαζεν· ἠναγκάζοντο γὰρ πολλοὶ καὶ βλαβεραὶ γίνεσθαι ὁμοδοξίαι ἀνθρώπων, τὴν δὲ φιλίαν ἀγαθὸν ὠμολογῇ καὶ πάντως εἶναι καὶ δικαιοσύνης ἔργον, ὥστε ταῦτ' ἔφησεν εἶναι ὁμόνοιαν καὶ ἐπιστήμην οὖσαν, ἀλλ' οὐ δόξαν. ΚΛΕΙ. ὅτε δὲ ἐνταῦθα ἦμεν τοῦ λόγου ἀποροῦντες, οἱ παρόντες ἱκανοὶ ἦσαν ἐπιπλήττειν τε αὐτῷ καὶ λέγειν ὅτι περιδεδράμηκεν εἰς ταῦτ' ὁ λόγος τοῖς πρώτοις, καὶ ἔλεγον ὅτι καὶ ἡ ἱατρικὴ ὁμόνοιά τις

ἐστι καὶ ἅπασαι αἱ τέχναι, καὶ περὶ οὗτου εἰσὶν ἔχουσι λέγειν· τὴν δὲ ὑπὸ σοῦ λεγομένην δικαιοσύνην ἢ ὁμόνοϊαν, ὅποι τείνουσά ἐστιν, διαπέφευγεν, καὶ ἄδηλον αὐτῆς ὅτι ποτ' ἔστιν τὸ ἔργον. ταῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐγὼ τελευτῶν καὶ σὲ αὐτὸν ἠρώτων, καὶ εἰπές μοι δικαιοσύνης εἶναι τοὺς μὲν ἐχθροὺς βλάπτειν, τοὺς δὲ φίλους εὖ ποιεῖν. ὕστερον δὲ ἐφάνη βλάπτειν γε οὐδέποτε ὁ δίκαιος οὐδένα· πάντα γὰρ ἐπ' ὠφελίᾳ πάντας δρᾷν. ταῦτα δὲ οὐχ ἅπαξ οὐδὲ δις ἀλλὰ πολὺν δὴ ὑπομείνας χρόνον καὶ λιπαρῶν ἀπείρηκα, νομίσας σε τὸ μὲν προτρέπειν εἰς ἀρετῆς ἐπιμέλειαν κάλλιστ' ἀνθρώπων δρᾷν, δυοῖν δὲ θάτερον, ἢ τοσοῦτον μόνον δύνασθαι, μακρότερον δὲ οὐδέν, ὃ γένοιτ' ἂν καὶ περὶ ἄλλην ἡντιναοῦν τέχνην, οἷον μὴ ὄντα κυβερνήτην καταμελετῆσαι τὸν ἔπαινον περὶ αὐτῆς, ὥς πολλοῦ τοῖς ἀνθρώποις ἀξία, καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν ὡσαύτως· ταυτὸν δὴ καὶ σοί τις ἐπενέγκοι τάχ' ἂν περὶ δικαιοσύνης, ὥς οὐ μᾶλλον ὄντι δικαιοσύνης ἐπιστήμονι, διότι καλῶς αὐτὴν ἐγκωμιάζεις. οὐ μὴν τό γε ἐμὸν οὕτως ἔχει· δυοῖν δὲ θάτερον, ἢ οὐκ εἰδέναι σε ἢ οὐκ ἐθέλειν αὐτῆς ἐμοὶ κοινωνεῖν. διὰ ταῦτα δὴ καὶ πρὸς Θρασύμαχον οἶμαι πορεύεσθαι καὶ ἄλλοσε ὅποι δύναμαι, ἀπορῶν· ἐπεὶ εἴ γ' ἐθέλεις σὺ τούτων μὲν ἤδη παύσασθαι πρὸς ἐμὲ τῶν λόγων τῶν προτρεπτικῶν, οἷον δέ, εἰ περὶ γυμναστικῆς προτετραμμένος ἦ τοῦ σώματος δεῖν μὴ ἀμελεῖν, τὸ ἐφεξῆς ἂν τῷ προτρεπτικῷ λόγῳ ἔλεγες οἷον τὸ σῶμά μου φύσει ὄν οἷας θεραπείας δεῖται, καὶ νῦν δὴ ταυτὸν γιγνέσθω. θές τὸν Κλειτοφῶντα ὁμολογοῦντα ὥς ἔστιν καταγέλαστον τῶν μὲν ἄλλων ἐπιμέλειαν ποιεῖσθαι, ψυχῆς δέ, ἧς ἔνεκα τᾶλλα διαπονούμεθα, ταύτης ἡμεληκέναι· καὶ τᾶλλα πάντα οἷου με νῦν οὕτως εἰρηκέναι τὰ τούτοις ἐξῆς, ἃ καὶ νυνδὴ διήλθον. καὶ σου δεόμενος λέγω μηδαμῶς ἄλλως ποιεῖν, ἵνα μή, καθάπερ νῦν, τὰ μὲν ἐπαινώ σε πρὸς Λυσίαν καὶ πρὸς τοὺς ἄλλους, τὰ δέ τι καὶ ψέγω. μὴ μὲν γὰρ προτετραμμένῳ σε ἀνθρώπῳ, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἄξιον εἶναι τοῦ παντὸς φήσω, προτετραμμένῳ δὲ σχεδὸν καὶ ἐμπόδιον τοῦ πρὸς τέλος ἀρετῆς ἐλθόντα εὐδαίμονα γενέσθαι.

Notes

¹ Clitophon was an Athenian statesman and thinker. He was involved in a coup that overthrew the democratic Athenian government and installed a short-lived oligarchy during the Peloponnesian War. He is an interlocutor of Socrates in Book I of the Republic 340a-d.

² Lysias was an influential Athenian orator, Phaedrus 277a ff. He is present at the discussion in Book I of the Republic.

³ Thrasymachus was a sophist who is famously depicted conversing with Socrates in Book I of the Republic 336b ff.